Chandra Jonnalagadda

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Education

Brown University — Providence, RI
Sc.M. in Computer Science (CGPA: 4.0/4.0) — *Expected May 2027*
- Advised by **Prof. George Konidaris**

Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Tirupati — Tirupati, India
BTech in Computer Science and Engineering (CGPA: 9.37/10.0, Department Rank 2) — *Nov 2021 – May 2025*
- **Thesis:** Beyond Expectation: Tail-Sensitive RL through Exponential Utility
- Advised by **Dr. Ajin George Joseph**

Publications

[1] **Hierarchical Reinforcement Learning with Temporally-extended Latent Action World Models**
Dan Haramati, **Chandradithya S Jonnalagadda**, Akhil Bagaria, George Konidaris
Under review at ICLR 2027
Model-Based RL in the Era of Generative World Models Workshop at RLC 2026 **(Best Paper)**

[2] **Noise-Gated Learning from Prior Experience for Generative Control**
Zilai Zeng, **Chandradithya S Jonnalagadda**, Patton Yin, Mingxi Jia, Zitian Tang, Stefanie Tellex, Calvin Luo, Yilun Du, Chen Sun
Under review at ICLR 2027

[3] **Latent Actions from Factorized Transition Effects under Agent Ambiguity**
Heejeong Nam, **Chandradithya S Jonnalagadda**, Harshit Aggarwal, Eric Xu, Randall Balestriero
Compositional Learning Workshop at ICML 2026

Professional Experience

Robert Bosch Center for Data Science and AI — Chennai, India
Summer Intern & Student Researcher — *May 2024 – May 2025*
- Advised by **Prof. Balaraman Ravindran**
- Investigated Explainable AI for Graphs to ground LLM reasoning in legal and medical domains.

Chimple Learning — Bengaluru, India
Software Developer Intern — *Jun 2023 - Jul 2023*
- Built a full-stack multiplayer quiz platform using React and Firebase, implementing real-time gameplay, authentication, and quiz management to support **300+** students across India.
- Designed and implemented a quiz authoring interface using React Hooks with Firestore-backed validation.
- Engineered a scalable session tracking and analytics system with Firestore, persisting single- and multiplayer game histories to provide users with detailed performance insights and learning progress.

Teaching

Artificial Intelligence (CS307L) — Spring 2025
*Head Teaching Assistant to **Dr. Ajin George Joseph*** — *IIT Tirupati*
- Delivered a lecture on zeroth-order optimization, simulated annealing and particle swarm optimization.
- Designed coding assignments on A* search, hill climbing, simulated annealing, and alpha-beta pruning.

Compiler Design Laboratory (CS301P) — Fall 2024
*Head Teaching Assistant to **Prof. Venkataramana Badarla*** — *IIT Tirupati*
- Designed and implemented an automated grading system to evaluate student programming assignments.
- Conducted weekly office hours to assist students with compiler construction concepts and debugging.

Introduction to Data Science and Machine Learning (ES109L) — Spring 2024
*Teaching Assistant to **Dr. Kalidas Yeturu*** — *IIT Tirupati*
- Conducted weekly office hours to assist students with course concepts, programming, and assignment debugging.

- Evaluated weekly assignments and semester exams, providing constructive feedback to support student learning.

Introduction to Programming (ES104M) Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant to ***Dr. Raghavendra Kanakagiri*** *IIT Tirupati*

- Conducted weekly office hours to assist students with course concepts, programming, and assignment debugging.

Honors and Awards

50% Tuition Scholarship Sc.M. at Brown University – Mar 2025

Academic Service

Reviewer

- NeurIPS AutoMLR Workshop 2026

Select Projects

Master's Thesis: Temporally-extended Q Functions for Offline RL Jun 2026 – Present

- Developed a temporally-extended Q learning method for hierarchical offline RL algorithms.
- Designed hierarchical model-based and model-free goal-conditioned RL algorithms leveraging temporally-extended Q learning to solve long-horizon tasks.
- Experimenting with 8 offline goal-conditioned locomotion and manipulation tasks from the OGBench suite and investigating performance improvements via data scaling.

Discovering Low-Dimensional Action Manifolds for Parameterized Control Mar 2026 – May 2026

- Developed a dynamics-aware variational autoencoder to learn low-dimensional parameterized action spaces from expert demonstrations, combining discrete action modes with continuous parameters.
- Integrated learned action representation space with model-based and model-free parameterized RL algorithms, outperforming continuous control SAC with 25× fewer online interactions.
- Demonstrated transfer to unseen task objectives in a custom box-pushing environment, reusing the learned action space without additional expert demonstrations.

Leadership / Extracurricular

IIT Tirupati AI/ML Club Jun 2023 – May 2025

Founding Member & Club Head (Jun '24 - May '25) *IIT Tirupati*

- Co-founded the institute's AI/ML club and helped develop the proposal and presentation for its establishment.
- Mentored 3 student projects (5+ members each) in RL, DL for Computer Vision and AI Agents.
- Directed a 27-member team in organizing workshops, hackathons, and talks, reaching over **500+ participants**.
- Secured 2 corporate sponsorships, boosting club budget by **185%** over college funding.